

Leo's Auto: quick interview

Opening:

"We're doing a small Towson University database class project. Could you explain how you track a repair from arrival to payment? We only need general information, not customer records. May I take notes?"

Date / time

Place or call/video

Student(s) present

Person interviewed

Their role

1. Quick business profile

Proposed site: Leo's Auto Inc., 14 Willow Ave, Towson, MD 21286. Confirm or correct the name/address below. Approximate answers are fine; sales can be "not disclosed."

History, location(s), staff/size, service area, main services, optional sales

2. What tools do you use now? Anything hard to track?

Software / paper / other; one issue or improvement (or "works fine")

3. Walk me through a normal repair, from arrival to pickup.

Who does each step? What is written down or entered? Include estimate/approval and payment.

Actual steps, in order

What information do we need?

4. What details do you record?

Customer details (e.g., name, phone, business/fleet account)

Vehicle details (e.g., VIN, plate, make/model/year, mileage)

Repair/job details (e.g., complaint, diagnosis, approval, status, mechanic)

5. How do these records connect?

Can one customer have several vehicles? Can a vehicle have several owners/contacts? Can several mechanics work on one job? What happens when a vehicle changes owners?

Answers / exceptions (yes, no, unsure + a short explanation)

6. How do you record labor and parts?

Labor: hours, flat price, or both? Parts: stocked or bought per job? When does stock go down, and what happens to unused/returned parts?

Labor pricing and parts/stock rules

7. How do approval, bills and payments work?

How is approval recorded? What makes up the total (labor, parts, tax/fees)? Any partial payments, deposits or refunds? Can an old invoice change?

Short answers; note anything we should ask about later

Finish with priorities and proof

8. What should a small class prototype do first?

Which 2-3 tasks, searches or reports are useful? For example, finding repair history, viewing open jobs or checking unpaid bills. Ask them to choose.

Top tasks / reports

9. What happens when something goes wrong?

Ask about a cancellation, declined work, wrong entry or missing part. One common example is enough.

Example and what the shop does

10. Anything to correct, or a question we should follow up on?

Business name / blank form / photo use permitted? Any restrictions?

Interview confirmation

This signature confirms that the interview above took place. It does not approve our report, commit the business to using our software, or endorse the project.

Interviewee signature (sign by hand): _____

Date signed: _____